WedTech Innovation Challenge

Issued by: Events by Athea - Wedding Planning Company

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About the Organiser

We are a full-service, high-end wedding planning firm operating across India's top wedding destinations — Udaipur, Jaipur, Mumbai, Delhi, and beyond. Each year we orchestrate 50+ multi-day destination weddings, each involving hundreds of vendors, thousands of guests, and budgets ranging from ₹50 Lakhs to ₹10 Crores.

Our day-to-day operations require juggling:

- Leads and client pipelines across multiple relationship managers
- Function-wise planning (Mehendi, Sangeet, Baraat, Pheras, Reception) for each wedding
- Vendor ecosystems spanning caterers, decorators, artists, AV teams, logistics providers, and more
- Complex Food & Beverage logistics — menus, tastings, bar licensing, satellite kitchens, crockery audits
- Real-time team deployment and task maker-checker accountability
- Client-facing communication, budget management, and RSVP tracking

Today, all of this is managed across fragmented WhatsApp threads, Excel sheets, and PDF checklists — resulting in missed follow-ups, budget overruns, and planning gaps.

Challenge Overview

We are sponsoring the development of three distinct digital products. Participating teams may attempt one, two, or all three products. Each product will be evaluated independently.

#	Product	One-line Description	Core Stack
P1	**Wedding CRM**	End-to-end operations platform for wedding planners	Web + Mobile
P2	**Wedding RSVP Platform**	Smart guest management & digital invitation platform	Web + API
P3	**WeddingBudget.ai**	AI-powered wedding budget estimator with decor & logistics intelligence	AI / ML + Web

Product 1: Wedding CRM

The operating system for a modern wedding planning firm

Problem Statement

Wedding planners currently manage every aspect of their business — client relationships, function timelines, vendor networks, team tasks, and checklists — across a patchwork of WhatsApp groups, Excel files, Google Sheets, and PDF documents. This creates critical failure points: tasks fall through the cracks, vendors are not followed up with, team accountability is impossible to enforce, and clients have no visibility into progress.

There is no purpose-built CRM for the Indian wedding industry that handles the full operational complexity of a professional wedding planning firm. The challenge is to build one.

Background & Context

A typical Indian destination wedding involves:

- 5–8 distinct events/functions (Mehendi, Haldi, Sangeet, Baraat, Pheras, Reception, etc.)
- 50–200 vendors across decoration, catering, F&B, AV, logistics, artist management, and more
- A planning team of 5–20 people with role-based responsibilities
- Planning timelines of 6–18 months, with hundreds of sequential tasks
- A checklist ecosystem covering F&B, décor, AV, logistics, accommodation, and services

The uploaded FnB Checklist (sample) illustrates the granularity required: each function needs category-level tasks tracked with specs, details, status, and notes — across catering, bar management, and service. This must be replicated across all departments.

Required Modules & Functional Specifications

Module	Description	Key Requirements
1. Leads & Pipeline	Full CRM pipeline from first inquiry to signed contract	• Lead capture with source tracking • Stage-based pipeline (Inquiry → Proposal → Negotiation → Booked) • Relationship manager assignment • Follow-up reminders and activity log • Conversion analytics dashboard
2. Wedding Dashboard	Per-wedding command center with function-wise status	• Wedding profile (dates, venue, guest count, budget) • Function-wise task breakdown • Maker-Checker workflow for task sign-off • Team deployment view per function

		• Progress percentage by category • Timeline and milestone tracking
3. SOP & Checklist Engine	Standardised checklists that auto-populate per wedding	• Master SOP templates per wedding type • Auto-generate checklists per function (F&B, Décor, AV, Logistics, etc.) • Hyperlink attachments (menus, PPTs, vendor sheets) • Status tracking: Done / Pending / Not Needed • Notes and specs fields per task • Admin ability to customise templates
4. Vendor Management	Vendor registry and follow-up tracking	• Master vendor directory (hotels, caterers, artists, decorators, AV, etc.) • Per-wedding vendor assignment and contract status • Follow-up log and reminder system • Requirement sheets per vendor per event • Payment milestone tracking • Vendor performance rating post-event
5. Data Library	Centralised knowledge base for the firm	• Hotel & venue database with capacity and pricing • Vendor database with categories and contacts • Design mood board / inspiration library • Past wedding archive for reference • Searchable and filterable interface
6. Client Portal	Admin-controlled client-facing view	• Admin toggles which data client can see • Client can view checklist status, timelines, menus • Client approval workflows for key decisions • Secure login per client • Mobile-friendly interface • Document sharing (proposals, menus, decor PPTs)

Technical Expectations

- Role-based access control (Admin, Relationship Manager, Vendor Coordinator, Client)
- Mobile-responsive web application; native mobile app preferred
- Integration-ready API for connection with Product 2 (RSVP Platform)
- Cloud-hosted with data security and privacy compliance

- Bulk data import from Excel/CSV for onboarding existing data

Product 2: Wedding RSVP Platform

Smart guest management and digital invitation platform — integrated with CRM

Problem Statement

Wedding RSVP management in India remains shockingly manual: Excel guest lists, WhatsApp message blasts, and follow-up calls to track attendance. Existing solutions like WeddingKart or Wedflow.in provide basic digital invites but lack deep integration with the planner's operational backend. The challenge is to build a best-in-class RSVP and guest management platform that is natively integrated with the Wedding CRM.

Background & Context

A large Indian wedding involves:

- 200–2,000 guests across multiple functions, each with different attendance
- Guests receiving invitations for only specific events (not all)
- Accommodation coordination for outstation guests
- Dietary preferences, seating arrangements, and travel logistics
- Real-time RSVP tracking to confirm catering headcounts and logistical planning

Required Features & Functional Specifications

Module	Description	Key Requirements
Digital Invitations	Beautiful, event-specific digital invite system	• Custom branded invite pages per wedding • Function-specific invitations (guest A invited only to Sangeet + Reception) • Multi-language support (Hindi, English, regional) • WhatsApp + SMS + Email delivery • Animated and themed invite templates
RSVP Engine	Smart RSVP collection and tracking	• Guest confirms per function they are invited to • Plus-one and children declaration • Dietary preference collection • Automated reminders for non-respondents • Real-time RSVP dashboard for planner
Guest Management	Comprehensive guest database and segmentation	• Guest profiles with contact, relationship, and group tags • Family/group grouping (bride's side, groom's side, VIP, etc.)

		• Accommodation assignment for outstation guests • Seating plan builder • Guest check-in app for event day
CRM Integration	Seamless sync with Wedding CRM (Product 1)	• Guest count auto-syncs to CRM event headcounts • Confirmed PAX feeds into F&B planning modules • Vendor briefing sheets auto-updated with RSVP data • Single sign-on for planner across both platforms
Analytics & Reporting	RSVP intelligence for planning decisions	• Function-wise attendance forecasting • Outstation vs. local guest ratio • Pending RSVP follow-up lists • Export to Excel/PDF for vendor briefing

Reference Benchmarks

Teams should study and exceed the functionality of:

- Wedflow.in — Indian wedding website and RSVP platform
- WeddingKart — Guest management and digital invites
- Withjoy.com — International reference for guest experience
- RSVPify — RSVP workflow reference

Product 3: WeddingBudget.ai

AI-powered wedding budget estimator with decor library, logistics intelligence, and artist cost mapping

Problem Statement

Wedding budget planning in India is an art passed down through experience — planners rely on gut feel and past project memory to give clients a budget estimate. There is no data-driven tool that can intelligently estimate a wedding budget based on city, hotel category, number of rooms, decor style, guest count, and service requirements.

The challenge is to build WeddingBudget.ai — an AI-powered budget estimation engine that scrapes real-world design references, maps artist and logistics costs, and delivers a client-facing budget estimate with intelligent ranges and itemised breakdowns.

Background & Context

A full Indian wedding budget spans six major cost heads:

- Venue & Accommodation — varies dramatically by city, hotel tier, and room count
- Food & Beverage — per-head costs by meal type, bar, specialty counters, staffing
- Décor & Design — the most variable cost; decor for a Mehendi vs. Reception varies 10x
- Artist & Entertainment — singers, bands, DJs, folk artists, choreographers, Bollywood acts
- Logistics — guest transfers, Ghodi (horse for Baraat), Dholi, SFX, airport transfers
- Sundries — room baskets, ritual materials, gifts, stationery, photography/videography

Planners today can only give rough estimates from memory. WeddingBudget.ai should make this scientific.

Required Modules & Functional Specifications

Module	Description	Key Requirements
1. Smart Input Wizard	Structured intake to parameterise a wedding	• City selection (affects base costs) • Hotel tier (5-star palace / 5-star city / 4-star / resort / farmhouse) • Number of hotel rooms blocked • Total guest count and outstation % flag • Number of functions / events • Bride & groom hometown (for logistics baseline)
2. Décor Intelligence Library	Scraped and admin-curated decor database with AI cost prediction	• Scrape 10,000+ design images across platforms (Pinterest, Instagram, wedding blogs)

		• Admin tags each design: function type, style, complexity tier • Admin seeds initial cost estimate per design • AI trains on tagged data to predict cost range for new/unseen designs • Client can browse library and shortlist designs • Budget auto-updates as client selects preferred decor references
3. Logistics Cost Engine	Automated transfer and conveyance cost estimation	• Detects if outstation guests require airport/station transfers • Thumb rule: 1 Innova Crysta per 3 guests (configurable by admin) • Fetches approximate distance from airport/station to venue • Calculates fleet size, trips, and estimated transfer cost • Ghodi (baraat horse) — fixed cost mapping by city • Dholi — fixed cost by number of dholis and hours • SFX (cold pyro, confetti cannons, etc.) — cost by type and quantity
4. Artist Cost Mapper	One-time cost database for entertainment acts	• Database of artist types: Singer, Live Band, DJ, Folk Artist, Myra Entertainment, Choreographer, Anchor • Named artists mapped to fee ranges (e.g., Bollywood Singer A: ₹8L–₹12L) • Generic tiers for unnamed bookings (e.g., Local DJ: ₹50K–₹1.5L) • Admin-maintained and periodically updated • Integration with budget estimator for entertainment line item
5. F&B Budget Module	Per-head food, bar, and specialty counter cost estimator	• Per-head cost by meal type (Welcome Dinner / Lunch Buffet / Gala Dinner / Floating Snacks) • Bar budget estimator (dry event / beer-wine / full bar) per head • Specialty counter add-ons: Chaat, Mocktail, Ice Cream, Tea-Coffee (24hr counter) • Catering staff cost by event size • Crockery and linen rental estimates
6. Sundries & Basics	Standard per-wedding incidental cost estimation	• Room basket cost per room (configurable by tier) • Ritual materials (Haldi, Mehendi, Pheras) — per ceremony estimate • Gift hampers — per guest, per tier

		• Stationery (invite printing, menu cards, signage) — quantity-based • Miscellaneous contingency buffer (admin-set %)
7. Budget Output & Client Report	Formatted, shareable budget with range and confidence indicators	• Itemised budget across all cost heads • Low / Mid / High range per item • Overall wedding budget range with AI confidence score • PDF/Excel export for client sharing • Scenario comparison (e.g., 5-star palace vs. 5-star city hotel) • Budget tracker to log actuals vs. estimates post-booking

Data & AI Requirements

This product has significant data and machine learning complexity:

- Web scraping pipeline to collect 10,000+ decor images with metadata
- Admin labelling interface (function type, style, complexity, initial cost seed)
- ML model to predict cost range from image features and admin-provided labels
- The model should improve over time as more admin labels and actual costs are added
- Cost data for artists, logistics, and F&B should be admin-editable and version-controlled

Evaluation Criteria

Criterion	What We Will Look For	Weightage
Functional Completeness	All required modules built and working end-to-end	**25%**
UI/UX Quality	Intuitive, professional, mobile-friendly interface	**20%**
Technical Architecture	Scalable, secure, well-documented codebase	**20%**
Industry Fit	Depth of understanding of wedding industry workflows	**15%**
Innovation	Novel features beyond the specification that add real value	**10%**
Demo & Presentation	Live demo quality and clarity of explanation	**10%**

Submission Requirements

All participating teams must submit the following:

- Working prototype / MVP (hosted or runnable locally with setup guide)
- Source code repository (GitHub link) with clear README
- Architecture diagram and tech stack documentation
- A 10-minute live demo video walkthrough
- A written product document (max 15 pages) covering design decisions, assumptions, and future roadmap

Judging Process

Round 1 — Document & Demo Video Review (shortlisting)

Round 2 — Live Product Demo to organiser's panel (final evaluation)

Round 3 — Q&A with technical and domain expert judges

Important Notes & Constraints

Teams should note the following non-negotiables:

- All data must be stored securely; no client data should be exposed publicly
- The CRM (Product 1) must have a working API endpoint for RSVP integration (Product 2)
- WeddingBudget.ai (Product 3) must include at minimum a working scraping pipeline and an admin labelling interface — the AI model may be at prototype stage
- Teams must not use copyrighted images or datasets without proper licensing
- Solutions built on no-code/low-code platforms (Bubble, Webflow, etc.) will not be eligible

We encourage teams to reach out for domain clarification sessions. A 1-hour Q&A with the organising wedding planner can be scheduled upon request.

We wish all participating teams the very best.

Build something the Indian wedding industry has never seen before.